

Chapter 6

After the chapters devoted to Julian's actions during the winter of 360-1 Amm. informs his readers of the activities of Constantius during the same period, which he passed in Antioch. The report is in two parts, *domi militiaeque*, sections 2-5 and 6-9, respectively.

Within the first part most attention is given to the miraculous death of the former *tribunus* Amphilocheus (§ 2-3), an anecdote which illustrates Constantius' prophetic gift. In this respect Constantius is a match for Julian, whose knowledge of the future has been spoken of in ch. 1 and 2. Moreover, the anecdote shows Constantius' clemency, which is surprising since he is consistently portrayed as a ruthless persecutor of *perduellio*, of which Amphilocheus is accused. For the treatment of Constantius in general as opposed to Julian see most recently Neri, 1984, who discusses this episode on p. 20-3 and quotes the relevant literature on p. 20 n. 47. He tries to remove, or at least to mitigate, the apparent inconsistency of this anecdote with the overall picture of Constantius by stressing the difference between the emperor's words in 21.6.2 and what actually happens in 21.6.3. It is true that Amm. plays down the supernatural powers of the emperor – probably the central element in the story as it was presented to him. But the reader cannot fail to draw the conclusion that the incident which befalls Amphilocheus (and he is the only victim: *efflasset spiritum reperiens est solus*, § 3) is connected with the emperor's prediction of the preceding day.

Probably Amm. would not forego telling this spectacular story, set in his home town, even if Constantius appears for once in a more flattering light. It has been noted, however, both by Cracco Ruggini, 1977, 115 n. 39, and by Sabbah 432 n. 100 and 441, that Amm. prevents his readers adopting too favourable a view of Julian's adversary by the malicious insertion of the words *lenior solito*.

In section 4 we read about Constantius' new marriage, which gives Amm. an opportunity to praise his former wife Eusebia for her support of Julian. The next section deals with the reception in Antioch of Florentius, whom we had taken leave of in 20.8.20.

The rest of the chapter describes Constantius' preparations, both military and diplomatical, for the new campaign against Sapor.

- 6.1 *Replicare nunc convenit tempora* For *replicare* see ad 20.9.6. Its present use may be compared to Cic. *Leg.* 3.31 *si velis replicare memoriam temporum*. The verb is used absolutely in 30.7.1 *replicare nunc est opportunitum*.

narrare summam Though Amm.'s account is indeed brief, compared with the five preceding chapters on Julian, *summam* is, of course, intended as the

traditional promise of *brevitas*, for which cf. 14.6.2 *summam causas persringam* and the note ad 20.5.3.

hiemans Antiochia Cf. 20.11.32 *hiematurus Antiochia*. For Antioch, capital of Syria and of old an imperial residence (Miliar, 1977, 48: "The imperial presence in Antioch is attested much earlier and more fully than at any of the east European cities; it begins indeed with the visit of the future Augustus in 30 BC") see first of all Downey, 1961 and Liebeschuetz, 1972. Cf. the notes ad 14.1.6 and 19.8.12.

domi militiaeque The expression is found only here; elsewhere (15.2.2, 16.1.4, q.v., 25.4.4, 30.9.2) Amm. prefers *domi forsique*. The same division of the emperor's main spheres of activity is found in Julian's speech (21.5.5): *domi moderatus...et in crebritate bellorum...consideratus et cautus*.

- 6.2 *inter complures alios honore conspicuos* The phrase *honore conspicuos*, for which cf. 29.1.12 *dignitatus et nobilitate conspicui*, is an untechnical designation of the *honorati* mentioned elsewhere as attending *officia* of this kind, e.g. in 22.9.16 (to which we shall return) and 22.14.4 (Theodorus) *profectum a civitate sua Constantium inter honoratos deducens*. In 22.7.1 we are told how Julian went *cum honoratis* to the New Year's reception of the newly elected consuls.

adorantur imperatorem peregre venientem The *adoratio* or *προσκύνησις* of the emperor was institutionalized by Diocletian: *externo ei regio more institit adorari*, 15.5.18 (q.v.). For another private audience see 17.10.9 with the note. The ceremony and its long history is treated by Alföldi, 1980³, 45-66, esp. 62-6 and Avery, 1940. Here the *adoratio* is part of the *adventus* or *ἐπιδημία* of the emperor, of which we have more than one description in Amm., e.g. 21.10.1 (q.v., Julian in Sirmium), 22.2.4 (Constantinople), 22.9.14-7 (Antioch) and above all 16.10 (Constantius' visit to Rome). See Alföldi 1980³, 88-93, McCormack, 1972 and 1981 and RAC s.v. *Hofzeremoniell* (forthcoming).

Peregre, which occurs also in 15.13.2, 22.13.3, 31.2.4, is found rather frequently in comedy. In classical authors it is used sparingly. Livy has it four times, e.g. 2.6.2 *alios peregre in regnum Roman accitos*.

ordinantur etiam ex tribunis insignibus Is *ordinantur* praesens historicum (Rolle) or does it describe a normal procedure (Seyfarth)? *Igitur* in the next sentence strongly suggests the latter interpretation. If *tribuni insignes* is an untechnical designation referring to *tribuni scholae*, this becomes even more probable, since it is stated explicitly in the Theodosian Code, be it at a later

date (6.13.1, 413 March 21), that those tribunes were admitted to the adoration: *tribunos scholarum, qui et divinis epulis adhibentur et adorandi principis facultatem antiquius meruerunt* e.g.s.

Ordinare here has its basic meaning 'to assign a place'. For other meanings see ad 20.9.8.

As appears from his translation "some illustrious tribunes" Rolfe assumes an elliptic construction, with the subject of *ordinantur* concealed in *ex tribunis insignibus* (cf. TLL V 2.1118.51 sqq. s.v. *ex*: "per ellipsin pron. 'aliquis' sim. adverbale ipsum subiecti vice fungitur"). This construction has no parallels in Amm., who in comparable cases always adds *quidam* (14.6.8 *ex his quidam*, cf. 19.11.10, 28.4.21, 29.3.3) or the like (e.g. 31.2.6 *ex ipsis quibus*).

The alternative interpretation 'former tribunes' (so e.g. Seyfarth, cf. TLL ibid. 1102.10 sqq.) on the other hand is quite often attested in Amm. (cf. e.g. 14.7.7 and 16.6.2 with notes), i.a. in the very next sentence (*Amphilochius quidam ex tribuno Paphlago*) where there cannot be any doubt as to the correct interpretation. In the latter case, as elsewhere in Amm., the noun depending on *ex* is in the singular, it is true, but 1) the plural of *ex tribunis insignibus* is sufficiently explained by the context and 2) the designation of a previously held office by *ex* followed by the title in the abl. plur. is common enough in later Latin (cf. e.g. *Cod. Theod.* 6.4.15 [a. 359] *Facundus ex proconsule et Arsenius ex vicariis* and see TLL, loc. cit., 1102.47 sqq. for further examples). It seems better, therefore, to reject Rolfe's suggestion and to opt for the alternative.

A comparable case in a Greek papyrus concerning an ἀρό βουλευτικῶν is discussed by Sijpesteijn-Worp, 1978, 13.

cum...hoc exciperetur officio In 16.10.5 we find mention of *senatus officia* and in 22.2.4 Julian is received in Constantinople *verecundis senatus officiis et popularium consensibus*. See also 22.9.16 *quo* (Thalassio) *adorare adesseque officio inter honoratos prohibito*.

a Mesopotamia reversus The Roman province of Mesopotamia, with its capital Nisibis, was part of Mesopotamia in the broadest sense of the word. Cf. Jones 1458 and see the notes ad 14.3.1 and 17.5.6.

Amphilochius quidam ex tribuno Paphlago Seyfarth's note ad loc. ("Amphilochius, ein Paphlagonier, war Studiengenosse des Libanius und unterrichtete dessen Söhne [Libanius, *ep.* 584, 585a, 549f], which follows Seeck, 1894, is misleading on two points. The man mentioned in Libanius' letters (*Ep.* 670, 671 and 634 respectively in Foerster's edition) was a Cappadocian, rightly distinguished from our *ex tribuno Paphlago* by Seeck, 1906, 59 and

PLRE I, Amphilochius 1 and 2. Besides, Libanius was the teacher of Amphilochius' children, not the other way round.

quem dudum sub Constante militantiem discordiarum servisse causas...pulsabant On *dudum* see ad 20.8.4. *Serere* in its metaphorical sense occurs again in 21.12.20 *Romulus...et Sabosius...convicti...studia servisse discordiarum*. It is found already in Verg. *A.* 7.339 *serere crimina belli*, Liv. 23.35.7 *ne qua exprobratio...discordiam inter ordines sereret*, Tac. *Hist.* 2.86.2 *serendae in alios inviolae artem*.

sub Constante For Constans, the youngest son of Constantine the Great and Fausta, see Seeck, 1901, Moreau, 1959, *PLRE* I, Constans 3 and Garrido Gonzalez, 1984.

inter priores tfratres Since Amphilochius, serving under Constans, in all probability sowed discord between Constans and Constantinus II, the brothers of Constantius (between them in 340 a war broke out, in which the former was victorious), the crux should be put before *prioris*. *Prior* does not mean 'the deceased' in Amm., nor, it would seem, in any other author. None of the proposed conjectures is convincing. *Primoris* would not do either, since Amm. uses it only of soldiers in the front ranks or army officers. *Principis* would suit the context very well.

suspiciones contiguae veritati is a carefully worded phrase. Amm. makes it clear that he believes in Amphilochius' guilt, as does Constantius for that matter, which only makes his clemency more admirable. The expression *veritati...contigua* in 26.1.1 has the slightly different meaning "connected with the truth" (Rolfe). See ad 16.2.10 for *contiguus*, on which Krebs remarks "nur bei weniger guten Schriftstellern, oft bei Amm." (1 354).

Pulsare is used repeatedly in Amm. in its juridical sense = *accusare*, e.g. 29.2.9 *praecipiti confidentia patricius columna ipsa pulsavit*. Twice we find *pulsata maestas* (14.7.7, 19.12.17) instead of the classical *laesa maestas*; Heumann-Seckel 478 and the notes ad 15.3.5, 15.5.5, 18.4.4 and Krebs II 426.

ausus paulo petulantius stare As it must be Amphilochius' intention to perform the προσηύδατος, it cannot mean 'he remained on his feet', as in 17.13.5 *stabantque contumaciter*, where Sabbah correctly translates "is restaient debout insolemment" (instead of prostrating themselves or at least bowing their head before the emperor, as in 30.6.2 *cumque membris incurvatis starent metu debiles et praestricti*). The meaning required by the context is 'to present himself', as Rolfe takes it ("having dared to appear").

ut ipse quoque ad parile obsequium mittendus Both Löffstedt, 1907, 82-5 and Pighi, 1935, 61 defend *mittendus* as simplex pro composito = *admittendus*, the latter adding that *obsequium* must be read as a trisyllable to produce a regular cursus (planus). There are no parallels in Amm. for *mittere* = *admittere*. *Admittendus* G is metrically and lexically attractive. For *parile* see ad 20.7.11. *Obsequium* for a concrete act of deference towards the emperor is found also in HA P 11.3 *qui* (miles) *cum e castris ad obsequium principis convenissent*; TLL IX 2.182.46-54.

strepentibusque multis...obstinatum Either we must read *strepentibus* (BA), or there must be a semi-colon rather than a full stop after *obstinatum*. *Strepere* is always used negatively by Amm., cf. e.g. 17.11.1 (q.v.), 19.11.7, 22.12.3 and 28.1.15.

Iniuri lucem in the sense of "vita frui" (TLL VII 2.90.28-33) is found for the first time in Cic. Mil. 7 *negant iniuri lucem esse fas ei, qui a se hominem occisum esse fateatur*.

ut perduellum et obstinatum For *perduellus* used both adjectivally and as a substantive see ad 14.2.1 and 20.8.21. Constantius was extremely sensitive to accusations of *perduellio* and even less inclined to clemency in this respect than Gallienus, according to the elogium in 21.16.9-10.

For *obstinatus* cf. ad 20.4.8 and Seager 30-1. In its meaning 'hardened', 'unrepentant' required here we find *obstinatus* in e.g. 19.12.2 *obstinatum fixumque...eius propositum ad laedendum* and 28.1.13.

circa haec lenior solito As has been said in the introduction, *lenior solito* is added to remind the reader of Constantius' habitual cruelty. *Circa haec* is best taken as a temporal adjunct, "on this occasion" (Rölfe); cf. e.g. 26.5.8 *circa id tempus*, 28.1.26 *circa hos dies*.

"*desinit*" *ait* "*urgere hominem...*" The sense of *urgere* required here, 'to keep on at', is found also in 15.2.8 *nefando assentatorum coetu...urgente*, cf. Tac. Ann. 15.67.1 *postquam urgebatur, confessionis gloriam amplexus*.

nondum aperte convicium In view of the fact that Constantius' brothers died more than a decade ago before the incident at Antioch under discussion (Constantine died in 340, Constans in 350), these words are surprising at first sight. Yet, when related to the end of the Amphilocheus-story told in the next section, there is no problem. The words anticipate Amphilocheus' accidental death, which was imminent and would prove him guilty.

mentote, quod The use of a *quod*-clause instead of *AcI* is discussed ad 20.5.10.

sub obtutibus meis conscientiae ipsis sententia punietur The idea that it is impossible to resist the emperor's penetrating glance is aptly illustrated by the following passage from Pacatus' speech to Theodosius after his victory over Maximus (Pan. 2.31.1), quoted by Neri, 1984, 22 n. 49: *an sustinere ne coram et solum oculorum tuorum ferre coniectum ille quondam domus tuae...vernula...potuisset*, which is the more striking because in the preceding section the *vis conscientiae* is mentioned. Pacatus returns to the subject in 43.5 *habet vero, habet nescio quos internos mens scelerata carnifices...ipsa sibi carnifex conscientia est* e.q.s. A similar concept is found in Symm. Or. 2.22 *obsidet oculis subiecta barbaria et intellegit sibi libertatem pro parte sublatam cui non licet habere secretum*, with which cf. *quam latere non poterit* in the present text.

Constantius thus provides protection for Amphilocheus until his trial, when the emperor's glance will make him confess immediately. At first reading, the future *punietur* refers to the time of that trial. It is only afterwards, when we have read the sequel of the story as told in section 3, that the emperor's words take a different meaning *ex eventu*.

There is an interesting parallel to this anecdote in 22.9.16, where it is told that one Thalassius, whom Julian hated, was not admitted to the *adoratio* of Julian, when he came to Antioch (*quo adorare adesseque officio inter honoratos prohibito*). The enemies of Thalassius then staged a mass demonstration asking for his execution, but Julian insisted on speaking with Thalassius first and was reconciled with him. The incident is introduced by Amm. as *patientiae eius et lenitudinis documentum leve quidem...sed mirandum*.

conscientiae...sententia About the warriors of the Limigantes we are told (17.13.11) that they were so proud that *minus criminis aestimabant alienis viribus potiusquam conscientiae suae iudicio vinci*.

6.3 *postidie ludis circensibus* Games in the circus were often held after the adventus (above, ad §2 *adoraturi imperatorem peregre venientem*) of an emperor in the city (cf. 21.10.2 *editio postidie curuli certamine* and see on this part of the adventus MacCormack, 1972, 723 and 1981, 42ff.).

Antioch is one of the cities mentioned by the author of the *Expositio totius mundi et gentium* (c. 32) as especially known for this sort of delight: *Habes ergo Antiochiam quidem in omnibus delectabilibus abundantem, maxime autem circensibus*. The capacity of its circus, estimated as 80,000, is the second largest known. "Our knowledge of it is quite extensive thanks to excavations